

Synthetic data policy

Rules for creating and labeling invented examples used in internal and client-facing materials.

AUDIENCE	All content authors, analysts and reviewers
PURPOSE	Prevent fictional examples from being mistaken for client facts or real-world evidence.
VERSION	1.0 As of 13 Jul 2026
OWNER	Keiko Ward Information Stewardship

Policy statement

Synthetic data may illustrate a method, layout or decision process when it is clearly labeled and cannot reasonably be confused with actual client, employee or market information. It does not substitute for evidence in a factual recommendation.

Required labeling

- Mark the table, chart or paragraph “Synthetic example data.”
- State the purpose of the example and avoid realistic identifiers.
- Keep synthetic examples separate from factual evidence and source notes.
- Do not mix synthetic values into calculations presented as client results.

Control record: minimum evidence for a review

Control point	Evidence to retain	Decision rule
Scope	Decision statement and named audience	Proceed only when scope is bounded.
Evidence	Source/assumption log and review notes	Separate verified facts from estimates.
Action	Owner, timing and next review date	Assign one accountable owner.

Application notes

Worked example: Client Alpha

Synthetic example data. “Client Alpha Phase 1 Finance approved diagnostic budget: JPY 42.8M” is a fictional illustration for this guide. It may demonstrate a scope baseline but must never be presented as a real client budget or loaded into production systems.

Creation criteria

Use invented names, non-identifying dates and deliberately bounded values. Avoid reproducing a distinctive record, transaction pattern, benchmark or confidential structure. If realism itself creates a disclosure risk, simplify the example.

Decision worksheet

Control point	Evidence to retain	Decision rule
Scope	Decision statement and named audience	Proceed only when scope is bounded.
Evidence	Source/assumption log and review notes	Separate verified facts from estimates.
Action	Owner, timing and next review date	Assign one accountable owner.

Practice note. Use concise records that make the next decision easier. This guide is an internal operating reference; it is not a substitute for engagement-specific governance.

Execution and review

Review and remediation

Reviewers must confirm labels are visible in exports and excerpts. If synthetic content is unlabeled or has been mixed with factual material, pause distribution, correct the artifact, notify the owner and record the correction in the review log.

Practical checklist

- Confirm the purpose and audience before working from the guide.
- Maintain clear distinction between verified facts, assumptions and synthetic examples.
- Record accountable owner, next step and decision date.
- Invite an independent reviewer when conclusions or access risks are material.
- Update the engagement record after the decision is made.

Sign-off prompts

Control point	Evidence to retain	Decision rule
Scope	Decision statement and named audience	Proceed only when scope is bounded.
Evidence	Source/assumption log and review notes	Separate verified facts from estimates.
Action	Owner, timing and next review date	Assign one accountable owner.

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